

Kosher Delight Yank's Blomberg

By MILTON RICHMAN

NEW YORK (UPI)—They always called it "The Search" and it's something they've been at now on and off the past 50 years.

The Giants went looking first. Then the Yankees went seeking the same thing, and finally the Dodgers came along and joined the search ...to a degree anyway.

What they all were looking for was "a good Jewish ballplayer." That was the way they always put it, but they were understating in a way. What they really were after wasn't merely a "good" Jewish ballplayer, they wanted a "great" one with whom New York City's 2.5 million Jewish population could identify.

The Yankees had a crack at a great one, a kid from the Bronx, but Lou Gehrig was playing first base for them at the time and Hank Greenberg decided to go with Detroit instead.

Blomberg is Special

The Giants signed several Jewish ballplayers—Andy Cohen, Harry Danning, Sid Gordon, Phil Weintraub, Harry Feldman and Mike Schemer, the son of an orthodox rabbi. Some were good, none great.

Only the Dodgers turned up a really outstanding one in Sandy Koufax and he never really attained greatness with them until they left Brooklyn for Los Angeles.

Now the Yankees seem to have something extra special in Ron Blomberg. He's 22, Jewish, and although the word never is over-used so much as it is in baseball, he could be great.

Ron Blomberg, at the

moment, leads the Yanks with a .347 batting average. He also has 19 RBI's and four homers in 41 games and already has caught on with Yankee fans. He knows New York's Jewish fans already are beginning to flock out to see him and that makes him feel good.

Awed by Stadium

"Everybody likes to have a following", says the blond, good-looking, left-handed hitting right fielder. "It makes you feel good to know that people come to see you."

Blomberg, who is from Atlanta, saw Yankee Stadium for the first time two years ago when the Yankees brought him up from Manchester in September.

"I was really scared when I walked into the park," he says. "You know, you always read about the place, and those monuments out there..."

Those monuments he means are out in center field and reading from left to right they

display the sculptured bronze features of such former Yankees as Lou Gehrig, Miller Huggins and Babe Ruth.

"When I'm finished playing I'd like to have a monument of mine out there, too," Blomberg says.

Reading that, it may sound presumptuous. The way young Blomberg says it though, it doesn't come out that way. He is not a popoff or a blowhard. He is merely a young man bent on making good at what he's doing. He has been called "a baseball nut."

"I am," he admits cheerfully. "I love coming out here every day."

Cheered up by Wife

Some nights it's rough going home though. Like one night last week after he went hitless against the Angels.

Blomberg's wife of 10 months, Mara, was waiting up for him even though it was

nearly midnight. She saw immediately he was depressed.

"Don't worry about it," she counseled him, wisely. "You're only human. You can't get a hit every day. Besides, you played pretty good in the field."

But overall "Boomer" Blomberg has been doing so well that some are reminded of the manner in which Andy Cohen broke in for the Giants here 43 years ago. The New York Times carried an editorial entitled a Daniel come to judgment and it said:

Times Praised Cohen

"Francis Hogan played well for the Giants in their opening game, but the Hogans have always played good baseball; so have the Kellys and the Caseys, the Dalehantys and the Bresnans, and the Wagners and the Zimmers. And the Lazzeris and the Chances have contributed stars for many years. But the Cohens?

The World Outdoors

By Hugh Barron

MONARCH OF THE MOUNTAINS: "Ages ago, even before the ice age, there still existed a slim land link between the North American and Asiatic continents. Some time during that period, roaming ancestors of our present wild sheep found the bridge and drifted across into the new world," reports Dick Dietz of the Remington Arms Company.

"Through the centuries the bighorn varieties spread southward, pushed perhaps by the advancing glaciers. But they re-

rams illegally. Let us call a hunter a hunter and a thief a thief, and not confuse the two. One abides by the law; the other breaks it.

"Dig a bit beneath the surface of a true sheep hunter and you'll invariably find that his pursuit of the regal ram derives as much from his desire to savor the wild, remote country he must traverse as it does from his long odds chance of taking a fine trophy. For these hunters the sheep will continue to offer the honest out-

combination hunting license. Any deer of either sex may be taken, but only during this special season.

TRAP & RIFLE SHOOT: The Wilmington Rod & Gun Club will hold a Trap & Rifle Shoot at the club range off Rt. 100 between Wilmington and Jacksonville on Sunday, August 29, shooting from late A. M. to dusk. Follow the arrows from Rt. 100. Trophy for 25 straight in Trap. Refreshments available.

NAFCA NEWS: J. Richard